Rachel Wiecking

UX Researcher

I'm a Mixed-Methods Researcher dedicated to humanizing high-stakes systems like healthcare through strategic insight and inclusive design.

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Empowering member agency: A competitive audit of prescription management tools

Benchmarking competitor insurer tools against retail and discount drug apps to uncover crucial gaps

QUICK SUMMARY

I led a competitive UX research study to understand how participants use their insurer and other retail apps to manage their prescriptions.

Using a task-based protocol that allowed for qualitative insights, I identified that **member preference for retail and discount drug apps like GoodRx isn't just a cost issue, but a symptom** of a chaotic market environment that insurer's are failing to mitigate.

I delivered a **functional inventory and visual roadmap that identified critical feature gaps**, providing the foundation for the client to align their digital tools with the do-it-yourself behavior of their members.

> "I'm just trying to afford my medications. Insurance [app] does not seem to want to help me do that."
>
> -P2, Female, 32

PROJECT OVERVIEW

My role Lead Qualitative Researcher

Client Large Regional Health Insurer

Study Duration 6 weeks

Participants
12 users of insurance Rx tools + at least 1 retail Rx tool to manage prescriptions (6 products total)

Methodologies
- Usability Testing, Likert scale ratings
- Qualitative Interview
- Competitive Audit

Key Deliverables
- Recruiting screener and discussion guide
- Visual UI Audit of competitor tools
- Analysis and Recommendations report

Impact
- Identified crucial feature gaps.
- Helped client align digital tools with member priorities

Humanizing Health Insurance: Shifting from Clinical Pushes to Trust-Based Engagement

Understanding the emotional drivers of patient behavior to identify how and when to reach out with help.

QUICK SUMMARY

I co-led a multi-phase behavioral design initiative for our client to **identify why traditional digital health interventions were failing to drive member engagement**. By using the Hidden Depth Method to map the emotional journeys of 42 members, we uncovered that **the primary barriers to behavior change were psychological rather than practical.** We translated these insights into three core design principles and ten validated 'interception point' prototypes, **reframing the organization's strategy from late-stage clinical nudges to early-stage emotional engagement that builds long-term member trust**.

> "The constant notification of your diabetes, your diabetes, your diabetes... it kind of gets old. It's like being micromanaged by a parent. I'm old enough to know that I need to take my medication. And if I don't, it's my choosing."
>
> -P8, Female, 46

PROJECT OVERVIEW

My role
Co-Researcher, Interaction Designer

Client
Large Regional Health Insurer

Study Duration
6 months

Participants
42 members across multiple health cohorts

Methodologies
- Two-phase qualitative interviews
- Emotional Journey Mapping

Key Deliverables
- 10 interception point prototypes
- Analysis and recommendations report

Impact
Reframed the organization's engagement strategy to build long-term member trust

Using Machine Learning to Improve Access to Wearable Tech

Makers of a gesture-based wearable seek to bridge the accessibility gap for users with motor impairments

QUICK SUMMARY

I led a double-blind longitudinal study for our client to **validate if personalized machine learning could help speed up gesture recognition for limited mobility users**. By combining instrumented gesture data with qualitative sentiment analysis, **I provided the evidence needed to prove that ML-adaptation is a viable path for inclusive wearable tech**.

My findings **identified a tendency in users to self-blame for system failures**, leading to incorrect perceptions of system response over the course of the study. In addition, **the Likert scale required by the client did not leave room for subtle differences in perception from day to day**, leading me to develop critical recommendations for improving future study protocol.

> “I was more frustrated today. I’m not getting this right... was it my right hand? It’s not closing the way it normally does.”
>
> -P10, Male, 48

PROJECT OVERVIEW

My role Lead Qualitative Researcher

Client Multinational Technology Company

Study Duration 6 weeks

Participants 10 individuals with limited manual dexterity/motor impairments

Methodologies Mixed-Methods Longitudinal Study with a Double-Blind Experimental Design

Key Deliverables
- Accessibility Synthesis Report
- Study protocol recommendations

Impact
- Validated ML-adaption as viable path.
- Recommended critical changes to improve perceived reliability and trust